

The Free Church's Second Annual Meeting

June 8–12, 1898

Working English Machine Translation

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Note on Translation

This working English translation was produced by machine using Aaron Dahlen's 11-step translation process. The process uses artificial-intelligence language tools for transcription, translation, comparison, contextual analysis, and consistency checks against the original Norwegian text.

The resulting English text has not been independently or comprehensively edited by a human translator. The 11-step process is intended to improve the quality and traceability of machine translation, but it does not guarantee accuracy. Difficulties may remain, particularly in archaic language, idiom, historical terminology, and theological expression.

The original Norwegian text remains authoritative. This English text should therefore be treated as a machine-generated working translation rather than a critical or scholarly translation.

Source files, translation materials, and revision history are maintained in the associated GitHub repository.

1 The Free Church's Second Annual Meeting

June 8–12, 1898

1.1 Wednesday Morning

The Lutheran Free Church assembled for its annual meeting in Trinity Church, Pastor Gjertsen's charge, Minneapolis, Minnesota, on June 8, 1898, at 10:30 in the morning.

The meeting was opened with the singing of Hymn 433, verses 1–5. Pastor Chr. Nrehus then delivered the opening sermon on 1 Corinthians 3:10–17.

Now that, after the passing of a year, we are again assembled for an annual meeting here in this church, it is surely with the desire and prayer in our hearts that the meeting may become a blessing to us and to our Church. But if this is to happen, then God himself must be allowed to lead us by his Spirit and by his Word. Only then are we enabled to do the Lord's work in truth.

According to our text, we will speak a little about the Lord's temple and its building up.

First, the foundation. When one is to build, it is of great importance that a good foundation be laid; for if one lays a poor foundation, one risks the house falling down and oneself being buried beneath its ruins. So also with the congregation of God. If a good foundation is not laid, the whole structure will collapse.

Now there is only one foundation upon which a true congregation of the Lord can be built, namely Jesus Christ. He is the great chief cornerstone upon which we all, as living stones, must be built up, so that together we may constitute a holy temple for the Lord. It was upon this foundation that the Apostle Paul built. It was the same foundation upon which Luther built when, as the foundation of his life's work, he laid this truth: that the human being is justified by faith in Christ alone.

Christ, then, is the foundation; but let each one take heed how he builds upon it. It is this admonition of the Apostle that we especially wish to lay upon one another's hearts at this hour. It is an exceedingly important work, this work of taking part in the building of God's temple, and we do well to examine ourselves, whether we build well and whether we use the right material.

The Apostle names several things as materials—gold, silver, costly stones, wood, hay, straw. He assumes that all these different materials will be used. He does not here specifically commend any one of them; yet it is nevertheless evident from the context and from other statements of the same Apostle that the right material is that which is here called gold, silver, and costly stones. He says in another of his letters: Come to him, the living Stone, indeed rejected by men, but chosen and precious before God, and yourselves, as living stones, be built up into a spiritual house, a holy priesthood, to offer spiritual sacrifices acceptable to God through Jesus Christ.

The right material, then, is living stones, stones that have been made alive, cleansed, and sanctified by God's Spirit.

There is no doubt that God wills to have a living, pure, holy Church, without spot or wrinkle. It is merely an excuse when one speaks of the invisible Church in order to cover over the infirmities of that which we call the congregation among us.

But there is little comfort in this for those who, according to God's Word, believe that the Church is to be light and salt in the world, the city upon the hill which cannot be hidden. There can be no doubt what the Lord calls his congregation. It is the gathering of all those who through faith in Jesus Christ have become living members of his body, which is the Church.

It is another matter whether here on earth we can bring the Church forth in its true form as a gathering consisting only of believing children of God who have been cleansed and sanctified by the blood of Christ.

We find that this did not succeed even for the Savior himself; for among the little company of disciples there was also a Judas. And the picture that the Apostles' letters give us of the first congregations also indicates that within them as well there was much that was impure.

But this is nevertheless no reason why we should continue in this country as we have done until now—practically driving our people together into congregations without asking whether there is spiritual life and real Christianity. I do not mention this in order especially to blame particular men or to place the guilt upon any single church body.

No, we all bear our guilt.

Many of us did it in ignorance; we understood no better. In many ways we were zealous in establishing congregations, church bodies, churches, and schools. We gathered people in great masses, large congregations, large church bodies, and we thought that things were going well. But what became of the Lord's congregation?

We must begin another course of procedure, and let us build from this day onward.

If we are to become true builders, God's Spirit must be allowed to take up his dwelling in our hearts, and we must not consult flesh and blood as to what I want, or what anyone else wants, but only look to what God's good and perfect will is. Let us begin in faith.

1.2 Wednesday Afternoon

Devotion by Pastor O. Dahle of Aitkin, Minnesota. The times for the business sessions were fixed at 9:30–12:00 in the morning and 2:00–5:00 in the afternoon.

It was resolved that a prayer meeting be held each day from 9:00 to 9:30 in the morning, and that the chairman appoint a man to lead these prayer meetings. It was proposed and resolved that the evening services begin at 8:00.

The chairman was instructed to appoint tellers. It was resolved that the chairman likewise appoint a credentials committee of three members.

The following were appointed tellers: Pastor C. Berntsen, Pastor J. M. Jakobsen, Pastor H. N. Hendrickson, and Pastor J. C. Fossum.

The chairman stated that all voting members of Lutheran congregations, regardless of denominational affiliation, could become voting members of this meeting by signing the following:

“The undersigned hereby declares that he approves the Rules of the Free Church and will work for its purpose as stated in § 2.”

The following were appointed to the credentials committee: Pastor A. J. Løgeland, Prof. M. Pettersen, and Mr. H. Paulson.

It was resolved to hear the reports.

The chairman, Pastor E. P. Harbo of Duluth, first read his report:

At last year’s annual meeting, the Free Church work advanced so far that laws and rules for a Lutheran Free Church were considered and in part adopted. It now falls to this annual meeting to continue the work further. The principles that underlie the work of the Free Church are not new. They are as old as Christianity itself. But among our people it was not until Hans Nielsen Hauge that they began in earnest to make themselves felt. With the Haugean Awakening in Norway there arose a division within the Church, a struggle between the awakened laity and the high-church and, in part, spiritually dead pastors within the State Church.

This struggle has continued here in this country. Those who favor ecclesiastical freedom have here set themselves the goal “to work for the quickening and liberation of all Norwegian Lutheran congregations, so that, according to their calling and ability, they may labor in spiritual independence and freedom for the cause of God’s Kingdom at home and abroad.” This was also established last year as the purpose of the Free Church, and we might readily have expected that all Norwegian Lutheran church bodies in this country would be willing to assent to such a purpose. Nevertheless, we see that they rise up in opposition to it.

The position of the Norwegian Synod in this regard was expressed by Chairman Koren at the Synod’s annual meeting in 1896:

“There is a phenomenon that is well known, though perhaps not so well understood, both in Norway and here in America, and which goes under the name of the western Norwegian Awakening, the sorrowful fruits of which, of various kinds, will remain fresh in the memory and can be recognized year after year by those who have a reasonably exercised discernment and insight into God’s Word. Unfortunately, it has extended much farther than many suppose. From it we will pray God graciously to preserve us. But if we are to have anything capable of standing against this pest, then it must be a true, sound Christian life.”

The United Church consists chiefly of Anti-Missourians who in spirit and disposition are still good Synod people. In this way it can also be explained why the United Church has with such bitterness persecuted those who have labored for awakening and spiritual life within the congregations.

In the United Church it is no longer a question of obedience to conviction and conscience, but first and foremost of obedience to the church body.

The task of the Free Church in this country is therefore plain and clear.

Amid tribulation and opposition, it must labor for freedom of conscience and personal Christian life within the congregations. To this task belongs also the maintenance of a theological seminary whose first aim is to train earnest, living witnesses of the Lord.

Augsburg Seminary has been such a school. In spite of the difficulties, the Seminary has also during the past year been highly blessed by the Lord. Enrollment has been greater than ever before. Eighteen young men graduated from the college department and nine from the theological department. The school, however, has not received the financial support that was needed, which may possibly be due to the unfortunate lawsuit concerning the property and the state of uncertainty into which the school has thereby been brought.

Whatever the outcome of the case may be, it will not have great influence upon the future of the Free Church. Its continued existence does not depend upon earthly property.

The possible loss of the property may, however, make it necessary for this annual meeting to take up for consideration the question of a future home for the theological seminary.

Since the previous annual meeting, Candidate J. Eliassen and Student C. Østerhus have been ordained.

During the past year as well, the work of edification throughout the congregations has been carried on with vigor and has borne good fruit in the conversion and salvation of souls.

Pastor P. Nilsen has again this year traveled about among our people and labored to great blessing. His work should be continued during the coming year as well.

Prof. Sverdrup read the reports of the mission committees, since the mission secretary, Prof. J. H. Blegen, was absent on a journey to Norway. The Committee for Mission to the Heathen had held four meetings during the year. Missionary concern appeared to be increasing strongly, as could be seen, among other things, from the fact that by the close of the year support had been pledged for twenty native teachers.

The committee had resolved to call and send out Candidate J. B. Jerstad as a missionary; likewise, it had already sent out two deaconesses to take charge of the orphanage in place of the late Sister Pernille Pedersen. The sisters at the Deaconess Home had collected about \$300 toward their journey.

Dr. J. Dyrnes and Candidate N. Hatlem had both offered themselves for service as missionaries. Missionary Tou, who is presently at home on a visit, is to travel among the congregations and speak on behalf of the mission cause. During the year, \$5,437.58 had been received into the foreign mission treasury. Approximately \$7,000.00 would be needed for the next year.

The Home Mission Committee had held seven meetings. Its treasury had received \$2,559.95.

At least \$3,000 would be needed for the next year. The committee wished especially to direct the annual meeting's attention to the missionary need around Fosston, Hawley, and

Wahpeton.

The treasurer of the teachers' salary fund, Prof. J. L. Nydahl, reported that from August 31, 1897, to June 1, 1898, \$3,579.24 had been received for the theological seminary through voluntary contributions.

The Board of Trustees was not yet ready to report; the chairman of the Board, Prof. S. Oftedal, did, however, read the report of the Seminary's director.

From this it appeared that the theological seminary had this year been blessed by the Lord in a special degree, in spite of the painful position into which the lawsuit over the property had brought it. This unfortunate lawsuit has, however, clearly shown that it is Augsburg's property, but not Augsburg's spirit, that the United Church wants.

Even if Augsburg's property is lost, the work cannot therefore cease. But we must reconcile ourselves to the fact that Augsburg's work for living pastors and living congregations will meet fierce opposition also in the future, and that it will require faith, love, and perseverance. But then we shall also be permitted to behold the Lord's help and rejoice in the fruit of our labor, provided that we are found faithful to the last.

The teachers at the school had this year been the same as before; but greater teaching resources and more room were needed. Instruction in English also had to be continued in the theological department.

A class in French had been established this year and led by the director.

The number of students this year had been 194, compared with 187 the year before. Eighteen young men graduated from the college department and nine from the theological department. Of the latter, two had a particular call to become missionaries.

A report from the Free Church Bookstore was read. The business had made good progress. Most of the surplus had been added to the capital fund. An appropriation of \$200.00 had been made to Augsburg Seminary.

The chairman read letters to the annual meeting from Pastors M. Falk Gjertsen and E. Gynild, as well as Prof. Reimestad, all of whom were traveling in Norway. A letter from Pastor O. J. Edwards, Cooperstown, North Dakota, was also read.

It was resolved to proceed to the election of officers. Pastor Harbo was unanimously reelected chairman.

The following were nominated for secretary: Pastor H. Yderstad, Pastor A. Helland, and Pastor H. Urseth. Yderstad received 16 votes, Helland 91, and Urseth 22.

Helland was declared elected. He stated that he could not well accept the election. It was then determined to elect an assistant secretary, and Pastor Yderstad was elected assistant secretary. Yderstad resigned, whereupon the question arose: How, then, are the railroad certificates to be endorsed? After some discussion concerning this, Pastor Yderstad was instructed to investigate the matter. Meanwhile, Pastor Helland asked leave to accept the election as secretary. The resignation was not accepted.

The following were nominated as members of the nominating committee: Prof. J. L. Nydahl, Pastor D. Paulson, Pastor E. Aas, Prof. G. Sverdrup, Mr. Jonas Hetland, Mr. Baard Andersen, and Fingar Fosliet.

Nydahl was elected but resigned. Paulson, Aas, Sverdrup, Hetland, and Andersen were elected. Sverdrup resigned, and Fingar Fosliet was elected in his place.

On the motion of Prof. Sverdrup, it was resolved to take up the “Rules for the Free Church” for consideration on Thursday morning.

In the evening, Pastors A. Halvorson and M. B. Sveen preached in Trinity Church, and Pastors E. Aas and N. J. Thomasberg in St. Luke’s Church.

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Folkebladet, June 15, 1898

The Free Church’s Second Annual Meeting.

(Continued from page 3.)

1.3 Thursday Morning.

Prayer meeting from 9:00 to 9:30, led by Pastor P. Winther.

Yesterday’s minutes were read and adopted.

The Credentials Committee reported through Pastor A. J. Løgeland that 52 pastors and professors, together with 80 voting delegates, had submitted their names.

A letter from Pastor S. Romsdahl, Calumet, Mich., was read.

Pastor A. Helland maintained his resignation as secretary.

Pastor H. A. Urseth was then elected secretary.

The meeting then took up for consideration the proposed “Rules for a Lutheran Free Church.” It was resolved to consider and vote upon the draft point by point.

“1. According to God’s Word, the congregation is the proper form of the Kingdom of God on earth.”

Prof. G. Sverdrup: It is of great importance that we express ourselves concerning these matters; for here the concern is not merely to adopt points, but that we also acknowledge from the heart what we confess in these Rules. It is something new when in Point 1 we declare the congregation to be the proper form of the Kingdom of God on earth; for through hundreds of years the Church has been called the proper form.

If we adopt this point, however, we go back to the time of the Apostles and to God’s Word.

According to God’s Word, the congregation is not a society founded by Pope, King, Council, or any other authority; rather, the congregation is the gathering of believing people around

God's Word and the means of grace. There is not a single indication in God's Word that any governing body is to be placed over the congregation to rule over it.

Point 1 adopted.

"2. The congregation consists of believing people who, through the use of the means of grace and the gifts of grace according to the direction of God's Word, seek their own salvation and eternal blessedness and that of all their fellow human beings."

Adopted.

"3. According to the New Testament, the congregation requires an outward organization with a register of its members, election of officers, appointed times and places for its gatherings, etc."

Pastor E. Hansen wished that the points might be discussed, so that more light could be shed upon the matter.

Pastor M. Midthun was of the same opinion; he especially wished the Committee to express itself.

Sverdrup maintained that it was a bad custom into which they had fallen, always waiting for the Committee to express itself.

As for the point, he would say that it was a very much disputed point among believers. Not all had come to the recognition that the congregation requires an outward organization, etc. Many believe that such an organization is harmful to the congregation. And this misunderstanding certainly has its basis in the lamentable conditions among our church people. It is a great misunderstanding when certain believers will not belong to the outward organization of the congregation, but leave the work of the congregation to worldly people—in order themselves to preach freely, as it is called.

The first Christians had a good accounting of the affairs of their congregations and did not leave them to worldly people. We even have recorded the names of the first members of the congregation (Acts 1:13–15)—a testimony for all times that believers were not found outside the congregation. The first Christians counted their people (Acts 2:41; 4:4). In Acts 6:2 it says that the Twelve called together the whole multitude of the disciples. They therefore knew who they were.

Many remain outside the congregation because they believe it is a dangerous organization. They feel more burden than support from the congregation; and therefore they withdraw. And there is reason enough to feel so and to speak ill of the congregation, such as it all too often appears among us. Nevertheless, it is necessary and biblical for believers to join themselves together for common edification and common work for the cause of the Kingdom of God. We must therefore hold fast to the congregation and ourselves stand within it.

Pastor Brøns: I am heartily in agreement with this paragraph. We must have a congregation, and a visible congregation, an outward organization. That there are people who are so spiritual that they will not belong to any outward congregation, we know; but we cannot

work in a proper manner by standing outside. It becomes only something loose, something upon which one cannot really get a proper hold.

There is much that is visible about us human beings, and the congregation ought also to resemble us a little in this respect—not merely resemble God.

Pastor Thomasberg feared that it would not be so straightforward to realize these principles under our conditions; for not many congregations correspond to Point 2.

Pastor Midthun: Many questions arise when one is to begin organizing a congregation. Some will have believers only, and no others with them; but this view leads to spiritual conceit, which in turn leads to a craving to judge and rule, and finally results in complete dissolution. And then one has spiritual fanaticism. We must have a congregation according to God's Word, with an organization in a definite place.

Pastor Hansen thought that the point distinguished between the congregation and the outward organization. He wished to have the words "for the sake of the work" added.

Point 3 adopted.

"4. The congregation's outward organization commonly also includes people who in God's Word are called dead and sleeping, for which reason within the congregation as well there is need of the counsel of awakening and the preaching of conversion, just as it is the holy calling of believers, also within the congregation, to be light and salt, so that outward connection with the congregation may not become a false comfort and a hindrance to true and living Christianity."

Pastor Midthun: God's Word would present a congregation without spot or wrinkle; nevertheless, we find that all the congregations of which we read had spot and wrinkle. It is not God's fault, but the fault and infirmities of human beings. Our goal ought to be to attain the ideal which God's Word sets before us. The speaker could not assent to the point as it stood, but wished to propose some changes.

Pastor Broen proposed that the point be omitted.

Jonas Hetland proposed that the word "hypocrites" be substituted for the word "dead."

Pastor Aas supported the proposal that the point be omitted. In any case he wished it to be redrafted. His understanding was that it is the believers who are to gather themselves into a congregation, and he could not see that there is anything dissolving in this. The love which drives believers together cannot be dissolving or lead to dissolution and pride. The life of Christ was not such. It was humility. Where the Spirit and love of Christ are permitted to dwell, there is no dissolution or pride.

The first Christians, however, were not afraid to confess themselves believers. If the congregation is to become visible, this must take place by the believers coming together.

Prof. Sverdrup: We must take care that we do not come to go against ourselves and our own principles. We desire awakening; but if this point, which speaks of awakening, were to be omitted, it would give the appearance that after all we did not mean it, or did not dare

to establish it when the matter was put to the test. If we desire a living, pure, believing congregation, then we must do something to preserve it living and pure.

We can easily, before we know it, enter upon the confessional principle that in the congregation all are believers, and all believers are in the congregation, and that for them the preaching of conversion is not needed. We must seek to labor in such a way that we do not work ourselves fast into such a position.

In the New Testament we find that the members of the congregation are continually admonished to keep themselves awake and not fall asleep. If it is to be established that a person is a Christian because he belongs to a congregation, or that a person is a Christian because he is a pastor, then we enter again upon the old unbiblical tracks.

The speaker was, moreover, also of the opinion that the point was unfortunately worded, and therefore proposed the following substitute:

“Since not all members of the congregation’s outward organization are always believing people, and since such hypocrites often take false comfort from their outward connection with the congregation, it is the holy calling of the congregation to purify itself both through the awakening proclamation of God’s Word, through earnest admonition and reminder, and through the exclusion of manifest and obstinate sinners.”

1.4 Thursday Afternoon.

Devotion by Pastor E. Broen.

The chairman then called the meeting to order. He then announced that the Augsburg Seminary Board of Trustees had received word that the Supreme Court of Minnesota had decided the Augsburg case in favor of Augsburg’s friends. This would surely bring joy to the hearts of the Augsburg people. That we had the moral right to the school none of us had doubted, and we could therefore now rejoice that truth and right had prevailed. Let us rejoice with trembling and thank God for his grace. Let the outcome become an inducement to us to support Augsburg Seminary, so that it may become a school for pastors in accordance with the requirements of the Free Church.

At the proposal of Pastor O. Paulson, the assembly rose and sang the hymn “Now Thank We All Our God.”

The chairman led in prayer.

The Credentials Committee then reported 20 new members as entitled to vote at the meeting. A number of advisory members were admitted, among them the brothers Holter, Pastors Oftby, Gaardsmoe, Winkler, and other members of Hauge’s Synod present and entitled to attend.

The Nominating Committee proposed the following committee on the Seminary Board’s report: Prof. Oftedal, Pastor E. Berlien, Pastor P. Winther, E. Nilsen, and Jonas Hetland. All elected.

For the standing Heathen Mission Committee: Prof. Sverdrup, Prof. Blegen, Pastor M. A. Pedersen, J. Berge, and Pastor E. Aas. All elected.

For the standing Inner Mission Committee the following were elected: Pastor Harbo, Pastor A. Helland, H. Rasmussen, J. H. Egeland, and Pastor E. M. Broen.

Ordination Committee for this meeting: Pastor Harbo, Pastor Midthun, Pastor Kjelaas, Pastor Løgeland, and Pastor P. Nilsen.

Standing Ordinator: Prof. Oftedal.

Organization Committee: Prof. Oftedal, Prof. W. Pettersen, and Pastor N. Halvorsen.

Auditing Committee: P. D. Olsen and O. A. Hain.

After these elections, discussion of Point 4 was again taken up.

Pastor Quanbeck: It is true, as has been said, that it is terrible that people should take the fact that they belong to a congregation as a certain sign that they are Christians, whether they are so or not. It is therefore not strange that many become apprehensive and remain outside the congregation. Here there are two extremes against which one must guard; but one must nevertheless not be so afraid of one extreme that one falls into another.

The speaker favored Sverdrup's substitute, since it expressed his standpoint more clearly.

Pastor Arewik had always found a contradiction between Points 2 and 4. In any case, the expressions were misleading. He could not, however, support the proposal to put "hypocrites" in place of "dead."

He had found it more difficult to convince hypocrites than openly ungodly people of the necessity of conversion. From the expressions "a whole multitude of dead" and "has left his first love," he found that even in the apostolic congregation there were those who did not belong to the Lord. Nevertheless, the goal is that the congregation shall consist of believers.

Pastor Broen would vote for Sverdrup's substitute. He would not have proposed that the point be omitted if he had known the substitute.

It had caused misunderstanding when in Point 2 one said that the congregation consists of believers, and then again in Point 4 that others also can be included.

We must express ourselves in such a way that we are not misunderstood.

He had, of course, not made his proposal because he was opposed to awakening, but because the former point was misleading.

Pastor Brønø: There is also a difference among hypocrites. Many find it easy to confess with the mouth, others more difficult. I am not prepared without more ado to acknowledge a person as a Christian merely because he smiles at me. Those who cannot so easily make confession are often more earnest Christians than certain facile talkers.

We can so easily be mistaken. I would therefore not take part in expelling from the congregation people who live honorable lives, even though I did not dare believe that they are living Christians. One has opportunity to purify the congregation through the proclamation of

God's Word and the preaching of conversion. Many believers are so carnal that when there is someone they do not like, they immediately want to get that person out of the congregation. We speak of the congregation as being without spot or wrinkle; but that is difficult to attain so long as sinful human beings are alive.

We have spoken much about the ungodliness of our congregations; but let each one examine himself, and we shall find that we are no better ourselves, but that we are among the most wretched.

Let there be more self-knowledge and humility.

Sverdrup's substitute was adopted unanimously.

Points 5, 6, and 7 adopted. They read as follows:

"5. The congregation itself governs its own affairs under the authority of God's Word and Spirit and acknowledges no other ecclesiastical authority or governing power over itself.

6. The free congregation esteems and loves all the spiritual gifts which the Lord bestows for its edification, and seeks to stir up the gifts and promote their use.

7. The free congregation receives [the source is defective here] the congregations can render one another in the work for the advancement of the Kingdom of God."

"8. Such mutual assistance consists partly in this, that the spiritual powers of one congregation benefit another through free meetings, mutual visits, lay activity, etc.,

and partly in this, that the congregations voluntarily and according to the prompting of God's Spirit cooperate for the accomplishment of such tasks as may exceed the powers of a single congregation."

Pastor P. Nilsen: I had not thought to speak in this matter, but only to hear what the other brethren had to say; I would nevertheless ask leave to say a little in connection with this point. I have been in serious doubt whether we ought to adopt these principles at all; I feared that we might fasten ourselves to these paragraphs and come away from God's Word.

In the course of my work in the congregations one thing has become clear to me, and that is that it is highly necessary that the simple truths of the Bible concerning the congregation be brought forward again.

All who proclaim the Word in the congregations must make earnest of this and help our people to greater light in this matter by again and again setting forth the truth of God's Word concerning the congregation.

If the Free Church is to advance toward a sound development, it is necessary that there be free interaction among the congregations. But this has its particular difficulties. There has been so much factional activity among us that the fear of something similar among us stands blocking the way. It must be clearly understood that nothing of this kind is intended by this; rather, when a visit is made to a congregation, it is for the purpose of building up, not tearing down or splitting apart.

Many excuse themselves and prefer to avoid taking part in the work; they would rather see others, preferably pastors, do it. The fact that one meets with ill will also holds many back.

When the congregations find that the use of the gifts of grace brings blessing and not trouble, they will become more willing to use them.

These many discussion meetings which are now being held here and there will surely, little by little, prepare the way for the use of the gifts of grace. It is of great importance that these principles be realized.

Point 8 adopted.

Points 9, 10, and 11 adopted.

“9. Among such purposes are mentioned particularly a school for pastors, distribution of Bibles and other writings and periodicals, Inner Mission, Heathen Mission, Jewish Mission, deaconess homes, orphanages, and other works of mercy.

10. Free congregations have no right to demand that other congregations submit to their opinion, will, judgment, or determination, and therefore every dominion of a majority of congregations over a minority is to be rejected.

11. Such common organs as may be considered desirable for the cooperation of the congregations, such as larger or smaller meetings, committees, officers, etc., cannot in a Lutheran Free Church impose upon the individual congregation any duty, bond, compulsion, or burden, but are entitled only to come forward with proposals and appeals and persons.”

[The final wording of Point 11 appears incomplete or textually defective in the source.]

“12. Every free congregation has, like every individual believer, the prompting of God’s Spirit and love’s right to do good and to labor for the salvation of souls and the awakening of spiritual life, as far as its ability and strength extend; in such free spiritual activity it is restricted neither by parish bonds nor by denominational boundaries.”

Pastor Yberstab thought that this point might require a more exact explanation; he could not assent to the final part. If it is adopted, one has thereby established as a principle that one may without further ado intrude into other congregations and use it as an excuse for carnal motives. The speaker then cited a series of statements by Luther against intrusion into the congregations of others.

Pastor Telle proposed that the final part of the point be omitted.

Pastor M. A. Pedersen was exceedingly glad for the point; he did not want anything omitted. That such free and unrestricted activity would bring its difficulties is certainly true; but that cannot be helped. As for Luther’s statements, he would only say that if they went against the statements of Jesus, then it was best to hold to Jesus.

I understand it thus, that Jesus wills that we bear witness concerning him to all without exception. Wherever there is an unconverted person, it is the duty of God’s children to bring such a one to God, even though he should belong to another congregation than ours.

Pastor E. Hansen wished to ask where it stood in God's Word that we are to let the unconverted go to hell because they belong to another congregation or another church body than ours.

Delegate Rørvik had the same question to ask.

Pastor Broen likewise wished to remind them that it does not stand in God's Word that one is to let people go to hell if they belong to another church body. He nevertheless believed that one would attain the same result even if the final part of the point were omitted; it would then not be quite so provocative. One ought to seek to avoid offense. But he favored free activity. It might sound strange; but in this respect he was willing to be un-Lutheran.

Prof. Sverdrup: The point is both biblical and Lutheran. If someone sends out a missionary or an emissary, we surely will not call that wrong. The New Testament knows nothing of parish bonds or denominational boundaries.

We would therefore not act contrary to God's Word if, for example, we sent someone to bear witness to our dear ones in the Fatherland, of whom we knew that they lived without fellowship with the Lord. That they might possibly shut him out would be another matter. But, for that matter, they do not do so in Norway. It is only here in America that one does such things.

Would it be wrong if we received into a hospital of ours a sick person from another church body? Let there be a free and open way. These parish bonds and denominational boundaries are something human beings have set up.

Luther, who has been cited here, stands before his Judge and not before our tribunal. If his statements are pleasing to God, then it is well; but we are not bound by everything Luther has said.

Moreover, we know from church history that Luther by no means kept so strictly to the old church order or within the old ecclesiastical boundaries. He was quite bold in that respect, yes, so bold that he was placed under the ban. If we become as bold as Luther, there will be no lack of boldness in the Free Church.

Point 12 was adopted in its entirety.

It was resolved that on Friday morning the draft of the congregational order should be taken up for consideration, and that a sufficient number of copies of the same should be printed for distribution among the members of the meeting.

The Credentials Committee then reported the following committee on the mission reports: Pastor O. Paulson, Pastor E. O. Larsen, Pastor H. Quanbeck, Mr. Fingal Fosliën, and Baard Andersen.

In the evening there was worship in Trinity Church by Pastor P. Nilsen, and an offering for the Inner Mission was received.

Pastor O. L. Torvik and Carl Amundsen in St. Luke's Church, Pastor Risløv in St. Olaf's Church, Pastor E. Hansen and M. Midtbøun in St. Peter's Church.

(Continued.)

THE FREE CHURCH'S SECOND ANNUAL MEETING

(Continued from the preceding No.)

1.5 Friday Morning.

Prayer meeting from 9:00 to 9:30, led by Pastor B. T. Petersen.

The minutes of the previous meeting were read and approved.

A communication from the congregation in Seattle, Wash., through Pastor B. A. Borrevik, was read.

They then proceeded to consider the draft of a new Congregational Order.

“Congregational Order for — — — Congregation — — —

Article 1.

The name of this Congregation is — — —

Art. 2. Confession.

§ 1. This Congregation believes and confesses that Holy Scripture, the canonical books of the Old and New Testaments, is the Word of God, revealed for the salvation and blessedness of mankind, and is the sole source and rule for faith, doctrine, and life in the Congregation.

§ 2. This Congregation confesses the ancient ecumenical Symbols, Luther's Small Catechism, and the Unaltered Augsburg Confession.

Art. 3. The Congregation.

§ 1. The Congregation is the Body of Christ. Col. 1:24. It is the city on the hill, and cannot be hidden (Matt. 5:14), the Zion from which God shines forth. Ps. 50:2.

As such, its members must, through the use of the means of grace and by faith, be united with the Congregation's Head and Lord, Jesus Christ.

§ 2. Every member of the Congregation ought, according to his measure of faith, to use the gift of grace given by God to each for the edification of the Congregation and the extension of God's Kingdom, according to the order and direction given by God's Word, and also, according to his ability, to share in the expenses of the Congregation.”

The paragraphs quoted above were adopted without debate.

Art. 4.

1.5.1 Membership and Voting Rights.

§ 1. Adults who are received into the Congregation must:

1. have been baptized with Christian Baptism,
2. show in confession and life that they seek first the Kingdom of God and his righteousness,
3. assent to the Constitution of this Congregation.”

Mr. Hofstad wished to know whether no distinction was to be made between women and men.

The chairman explained that this question would be dealt with under a later point.

Prof. Sverdrup thought that in item 2 a peculiar passage of Scripture had been inserted—merely a general exhortation, which set no definite condition for admission into the Congregation.

Pastor Aas: The committee was not agreed on this point. The wording is unfortunate. I have not been able to go along with the point. The passage of Scripture contains only a general exhortation and is not a sufficiently clear expression of what ought to be required as a condition for admission into the Congregation.

It can be understood in so many ways. I therefore have a minority recommendation, which reads as follows: “in life and confession testify that through faith they are united with the Head of the Congregation, Jesus Christ.”

I think this is more consistent with what has been proposed concerning confirmands—that they must have come to conscious faith.

If this is required of confirmands, then it seems to me that one ought also to require at least so much of adults who wish to enter the Congregation.

Delegate Blomlie thought there was an inconsistency between this paragraph and a later one. It is not laid down here as a condition for admission into the Congregation that one must have been confirmed, while it is made a condition for obtaining the right to vote.

Pastor Winther believed it was of great importance that this point be thoroughly discussed. From one point of view, it may not matter so greatly what is adopted here; for the draft is only a model, not a binding law for the congregations. Yet it is good to discuss the matter.

The exceedingly difficult point is the question of the admission of adults into the Congregation. The minority recommendation seemed to require a conscious life with the Head, Jesus Christ. To this belongs also, in my opinion, participation in the Lord’s Supper; but how is all this to take place with a person outside the Congregation?

I do not believe that a person can come to a conscious life with the Head, Jesus Christ, outside the Congregation.

We have also previously had good conditions for admission into the Congregation; but it is one thing to have them on paper, another to put them into practice. I am, however, not

satisfied with the old order; I therefore rejoice over every step in the direction of reform. Yet I do not believe it is so imperative to include these definite rules with a requirement for these definite marks. What matters, rather, is the inward spiritual work. If vigorous spiritual work is done in the Congregation, people will as a rule not apply for admission before they also have the proper qualifications for it.

If spiritual need is present, then I do not think one ought to require that they have come to a conscious faith. There is also something in the Christian life called longing faith; therefore I cannot go along with the minority recommendation.

Jonas Helland: It may perhaps seem strange that we could not agree in the committee. We could, however, agree well enough concerning the wording of the minority recommendation, but not concerning its interpretation. We did not believe that the penitent and those who are seeking ought to be excluded from the Congregation, even though they lacked confident, conscious faith.

Faith has its development; longing and seeking are signs of faith beginning. There are those who never seem to come to this confident, conscious faith, but who nevertheless show in their lives that they walk with the Lord. The Savior himself calls those blessed who hunger and thirst for righteousness. Why, then, should we not give such persons access to the Congregation?

Theod. Johnson: The previous speaker has in substance presented what I wished to say. It is true that many are seeking for a long time before they come to conscious faith; so it was with me. I think it is harsh to exclude those who are seeking.

I would therefore express it in this way: “who show that they are truly seeking.”

Pastor Arevig: I think a different requirement is set forth in III, 1 and IV, 2. Those who are admitted ought to stand approximately on the same spiritual level as those who admit them; otherwise there will be no true union. I therefore favor the minority recommendation, since it refers back to III, 1.

Pastor Midthun: This point comes very near the same matter that we discussed under “guiding principles.” I will say here also that one is in danger of going too far. I fear that this will lead to carnal zeal and spiritual domineering. I think III, 1 and IV, 2 speak of two different things; the former point speaks of how one becomes a child of God, the latter of what conditions are to be set for admission into the Congregation. I am more inclined toward the majority recommendation.

Pastor Kjeldas thought the point was strict enough without any amendment. He wished especially to call attention to the difficulties on the mission field. How can one there demand conscious faith as a condition for admission into the Congregation? And how can the missionary pastor come to know the spiritual condition of the individual? He is most often unacquainted with them and comes there only seldom—who, then, is to testify to the genuineness of the people’s Christianity?

Moreover, one can so easily be mistaken and judge wrongly; I have myself experienced this. I am afraid one may get onto a slippery slope, become like the “Free-Free,” and pass over both

repentance and conversion.

Pastor Birkeland: I have exceedingly little faith in written rules. As the members of the Congregation are, so the Congregation is—not as the rules are.

In this connection I shall quote a statement by Prof. Böckman; I do so all the more readily because it comes from a quarter from which one would least expect it.

Prof. Böckman said that all congregations in this country, so far as he knew them, were based upon a lie. They begin with a lie by admitting anyone and everyone without asking whether they are believers.

Nevertheless, it is good to have an expression of how members of the Congregation are to be admitted. The principal matter, however, is not to guard oneself against unbelief, but that all believers be included. The Congregation cannot afford to leave any believing soul outside. Christ's Body and Blood cannot be cut apart; and when we exclude those who belong to Jesus' Body, what are we doing other than cutting it apart?

The expressions in the point are too indefinite. Everyone will say that they seek first the Kingdom of God and his righteousness, but each understands it in his own way.

But then comes the question: Have we the right to require of those who seek admission that they must be able to answer with a definite Yes that through faith they are united with Christ? The principal matter in the confession is not that one can stand up and say: I am converted; I believe—it is all well and good, and I rejoice over everyone who can confess it; neither am I so terribly afraid of the “Free-Free”—but the principal matter is not what one can confess about oneself; the question is: What do you think of Christ? One must be able to say something about Jesus, confess something about him. There is altogether too little testimony concerning Jesus in our time—even in public preaching.

If there is to be a condition, then let it be this: What can you say about Jesus? What may a person not confess about himself when hard pressed!

No, let them confess something about Jesus—even if no more than the old woman who said: I cannot say much about him; but this I know, that I love him so that I would gladly die for him.

Prof. Sverdrup: One can also speak falsely about Jesus. One may adopt certain insipid phrases about Jesus and mean very little by them. So neither is that any sure sign of true life in God.

The difficulty is not admission into the Congregation, but the difficulties must be considered in connection with the Congregation itself. Who is to admit? What is the Congregation like?

When the Congregation is worldly, and the pastor is worldly, they naturally admit such as are like themselves. If, on the other hand, one had an assembly of believers and a believing pastor, there would not be such great difficulties with admission into the Congregation.

As conditions are in most places, it is simply impossible to bring matters into proper order. An abuse is prevalent. Many enter the Congregation in order to obtain a security with respect to eternity; others wish to obtain protection against attacks upon sins and vices within the

Congregation. When, for example, a pastor takes a stand against youthful excesses, people are brought into the Congregation in order to drive the pastor away.

It is therefore right to be quite exacting about admission into the Congregation; above all, one must admit man by man, person by person. Admission in this connection means nothing other than that one gives those who are admitted an opportunity to participate in governing the Congregation, not that one prescribes to them how they are to be Christians or gives them access to hearing God's Word.

The stricter one is, the better. One thereby prevents no one from salvation and blessedness.

A person can be saved even though his name is not in the congregational register.

From God's Word we see that those who were baptized and saved were also added to the Congregation. If, now, a congregation wished to draw a boundary and say: only when you have come to conscious faith can you participate in governing the Congregation, it surely has the right to do so.

I would prefer to word the point differently, so that it might agree with VII, 4, where it says that the Congregational Council shall "investigate whether those who request admission into the Congregation possess the necessary qualifications for it." There ought to be some testimony, and preferably the testimony of those who have examined the person concerned.

Pastor Broen: The principal matter at this meeting is not to establish something definite, but that a great many thoughts may be brought forth and shed light upon the matter; for that is needed. We need counsel and direction concerning how one ought to proceed in admitting new members.

Something new is pressing its way forward. And it is probably now as before, that the new wine will burst the old wineskin. The believers in the Congregation see that things are wrong as they are. And that is true. There must be some testimony concerning what Christ has been able to accomplish in them.

Suppose now that the Congregation has elected believing deacons. Applications for admission are presented to them, and they are to act according to their new light; then the difficulties arise, for there comes to be such a striking contrast between the new and the old. And there will be severe conflicts when one begins to put the new into practice.

I have never liked the committee's recommendation; I do not think it is much better than what we have had before.

If one were without more ado to admit seekers, one would get a great many wavering, indefinite persons who would not be added to the working force against evil, but would instead occupy an indefinite neutral position. If greater conflicts arise, they nevertheless tend to place themselves on the side of the world.

1.6 Friday Afternoon

Devotion by Pastor M. A. Pedersen of St. Paul.

The Credentials Committee reported 16 new members of the meeting.

It was resolved to give Rev. Fenton of St. Paul an opportunity to speak for ten minutes concerning secret societies.

It was resolved to take an offering for the Deaconess Home at the evening service.

Pastor O. L. Jordvik proposed that it should become the practice among the pastors in the Free Church to divide travel expenses equally.

Prof. Nybahl thought that this could not simply be done by a hasty resolution, and therefore proposed that a committee of three members be appointed to take the matter under consideration and later report to the meeting.

The latter proposal was adopted.

The following were elected to the committee: Pastor O. L. Jordvik, Pastor M. A. Pedersen, and Pastor J. H. Brønø.

Pastors K. O. Lundeberg, J. Tollefson, and S. M. Stenby were admitted as advisory members of the meeting.

At the proposal of Pastor Broen, a collection was taken for the benefit of a sick man from Stordal Congregation. The man was poor and had recently come to the city to seek medical help.

They then proceeded to the order of the day, which was the continued consideration of the draft of the Congregational Order.

Pastor P. Nielsen: There seems to be great anxiety lest we should come to admit too many into the Congregation. My anxiety has not precisely been that; what concerns me is the Congregation itself, what it is like. If the Congregation has its proper constitution, if it is led by the Spirit of God, then it will surely also be quite careful in admitting new members.

It may be that the committee has not been able to express itself rightly concerning the Congregation; but it is one thing to express ideally what it ought to be, another to realize it. What I, for my part, had in view was this: that the Congregation ought to place itself on the side of the Spirit of God and not in opposition to the Spirit or his work.

The Spirit does not work only within a congregational organization, but everywhere God's Word sounds forth. If the Holy Spirit has begun his work in a human heart, that person will also be drawn to those who belong to the Christian Congregation; I have experienced it myself.

If one now asks the person seeking admission: What is your confession? and he answers: I cannot give any definite confession; but I seek Jesus—would it then be right to deny such a person admission into the Congregation? I do not believe so. Perhaps such a person is every bit as sincere as the one who can give a confident testimony.

One can also force that kind of confession and get people to bring forth with their mouths the desired testimony without possessing in the heart what corresponds to it.

I know that there is danger here also. Carnal congregations will misuse this point, just as they will misuse any other point one adopts.

It is, however, not human beings but the Spirit of God who adds to the Congregation. The Lord adds to the Congregation those who are being saved. But cannot these people wait and remain outside until they come to a greater measure of faith? one says.

(Continued on page 4.)

THE FREE CHURCH'S SECOND ANNUAL MEETING

(Continued from page 3.)

We must seek to stand in agreement with the Spirit of God and his work. If the Spirit adds them, we ought not set ourselves against it.

I have seen how they have proceeded where conscious faith is required. They have produced a kind of spiritual excitement and thereby forced forth the desired confession, but in a manner that has become harmful to the work of God's Kingdom.

Ole Pedersen: It has become clear to me, from what I heard yesterday and today, that people fear we have now become so Christian that we are going to become too strict in admitting new members. I do not believe, however, that the minority has become quite so Christian yet. One may be sure that wherever the worldly-minded are in the majority, they will continue to be quite lax. Until there is awakening and quickening in the congregations as they now are, there will be no danger in that respect.

Until now people have not asked about Christianity, but rather about money. The situation is now such that I can see no way out. So long as all the work is left to the pastors alone, little can be done; for as a rule they are overloaded and have too large a field of labor. I have often thought of what Skrefsrud said about how they do it in Santalistan, that there they go out two by two to speak with people. Think if we did the same? Can we?

Pastor Quambeck: The question before us is to obtain a rule in accordance with God's Word, whether the congregations are sleeping or not.

We are surely agreed that all who are to be added to the Congregation ought to belong to the Lord. I also believe that they ought to show it in confession and life.

It was resolved that a vote should be taken.

It was proposed that the point be referred back to the committee. Defeated.

The point—the majority recommendation—was adopted.

“§ 2. All children become members of the Congregation through Baptism.”

Ole Pedersen: It is a well-known fact that pastors baptize children of parents who stand outside the Congregation; is this to be understood to mean that these children also become members of the Congregation through Baptism? I have never liked pastors having various

little jobs outside the Congregation. Did the first Christians do anything of the kind? We act thoughtlessly.

For a long time I thought this was something the pastors did on their own. But then I asked our own pastor about it. He said that he could not do such a thing at all except as the servant of the Congregation.

Are children of outsiders to become members of the Congregation through Baptism?

Pastor Helland wished to ask the same question.

It would be clear and intelligible if there were added: “of parents who belong to the Congregation.”

As a pastor, he wished to receive guidance in this matter. City pastors are exposed here to distress of conscience, more so than country pastors. He hoped there would be a clear and definite understanding of this difficult question.

Are we to baptize children of godless parents, and are such children then to belong to the Congregation?

Pastor D. Paulson: This is an old story. The church bodies have never succeeded in regulating the matter. It applies to weddings and funerals just as much as to Baptism. If we do not perform these things, others will.

God’s Word says: Let the little children come to me and do not hinder them, for the Kingdom of God belongs to such as these.

Now I know that the child becomes a child of God through Baptism; is it then right for me to deny it the Kingdom of God because of the parents? I am so situated that I even sometimes receive requests from Germans to baptize their children, and I do it; but they do not thereby become members of our Norwegian congregations.

Pastor Winther thought it was painful to hear people call baptizing children “jobbing”—a rather ugly insinuation. In this matter I stand approximately at the same point as Pastor Paulson. I have not been able to say no to the Baptism of little children.

Pastor P. Nielsen: The point is clear enough. I will only ask: Are the children members of the Congregation before they are baptized? Do they become members of the Congregation when they are baptized and brought to Christ?

The question here is not one of practice, but of God’s Word, and it says: Go therefore and make all nations my disciples, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, and teaching them to keep all that I have commanded you. Here we are commanded not only to baptize, but also to teach. Shall one then baptize children indiscriminately without also seeing to their instruction in God’s Word?

I believe there is some limitation upon the use of Baptism; there are cases in which the Congregation must say no.

Can these parents who stand outside not baptize their children themselves? Why should the pastor assume a responsibility that he need not take upon himself? Let these people baptize

their own children if they wish to have them baptized. Or do we Lutherans perhaps teach that it is no valid Baptism unless the pastor performs it?

We do not teach that. We ourselves are to blame that many people wish to make use of pastor and Congregation for certain “jobs,” while at the same time in their hearts they despise both pastor and Congregation.

People say: If we do not do it, then others will—is that any argument for doing what is wrong? We must give some thought to the responsibility involved in the use of the means of grace.

If we determine that children “of parents who belong to the Congregation” become through Baptism members of the same, is that then to mean that children of other parents stand differently? Does not Baptism work the same in both cases? Does it work in two different directions? Baptism always works in the same way, whether the parents belong to the Congregation or not.

Pastor Chr. Jirehus held the same view as Nielsen. If the Congregation baptizes children, then it also has responsibility that they be instructed in Christian doctrine for children and in God’s Word. It ought also to be regarded in this way, that children baptized in the midst of the Congregation are members of it; for it is altogether easier to keep oversight of those who belong to the Congregation than of those who stand outside. And it ought to be understood that when the Congregation baptizes children, it will also have the right to bring them up.

Baard Andersen was against drawing the bonds too tight. One can so easily place hindrances in the way of the work of God’s Spirit in the Congregation, hindering the little ones from coming to Christ. To illustrate what he meant, he told of a case from his own congregation.

There was a married couple who did not belong to the Congregation. The man associated with the sects; but the mother adhered to the Lutherans. She also wished to have the children baptized. They were baptized. As they grew older, they were also sent to the Lutheran religious school. One of the children, now a young man, stands today as a respected member of the Congregation and is a great blessing to it. Would this have been the case if the Congregation had denied these children Baptism?

I am not in favor of setting bounds to the activity of pastors; but I believe it is best to let the pastor act according to his conviction.

Let us proceed cautiously and not go forward too quickly or too violently; for if one takes things too abruptly and too forcefully, conflict and division will follow.

Pastor E. Hansen: There is no doubt that this question of baptizing children of parents who stand outside the Congregation becomes a matter of conscience. The worst thing is that one is tempted to try to make God’s Word fit what is wrong.

I have read about the Catholics’ missionary work, how they steal children, baptize them, confirm them, and make them Catholics for life. Are we to practice something similar?

I am in favor of the children becoming members of the Congregation through Baptism, and of their being reminded of it when they grow up.

Jonas Helland: What we in the committee meant was that when the pastor baptizes children on behalf of the Congregation, they become members of the same. What he does on his own account is his affair. For that matter, I doubt whether he has any call at all to baptize without the consent of the Congregation.

Pastor Aas: It is not stated in the point that one is not to baptize children of parents who stand outside the Congregation. What we thought in the committee was this: that one had no right to baptize children over whom one could afterward exercise no oversight. The Congregation ought not baptize children of parents who neither will themselves bring up their children in Christianity nor permit the Congregation to do so. That others baptize them if we do not is something we cannot help.

It sounds ugly to call it “jobbing”; but the worst of it is that it is true.

Theo. Johnson: The point is unclear. I would like it better if it had said that all children become “born again,” or “members of the invisible Church.”

There is also a difference among those who stand outside. If I were a pastor, I would have the parents sign a declaration in which they promised to bring up their children in the Christian faith.

It was resolved to cut off the debate and proceed to a vote.

Point 2 was adopted.

“§ 3. Entitled to vote in this Congregation are all members who are over 21 years of age, confirmed, and not under congregational discipline.”

Pastors Thomasberg and Broen each had an amendment to the point. The former’s received no second. Broen wished to insert the words “who have access to the Lord’s Supper” instead of “who are over 21 years of age.” His amendment was seconded.

Pastor Yderstad: I do not like the word “all” members; I therefore propose that the word “male” be added.

I am still so conservative that I do not believe it is right to give women the vote. I believe it is good for us to take a little time and consider what we are doing before we proceed too hastily. The Free Church is surely the most progressive among the Norwegian-Lutheran church bodies in this country, and I am glad of it; but we are in danger of becoming too progressive. And it must not be taken amiss if someone tries to hold back. I, for one, will try to do so. Let there be a little calm and steady progress among us. This question will surely awaken conflict, and we do well to think of that also. I propose that we conclude consideration of this draft for this year.

The proposal failed.

Mr. Hofstad knew of congregations that had introduced voting rights for women. No unpleasantness had arisen on that account; rather, it had worked for blessing.

Prof. Oftedal: I am one of the conservatives and can well understand the misgivings some have.

We must make ourselves familiar with the fact that reforms are of little use unless they are borne by personal conviction.

At the same time, we must remember that our provisions are binding upon no one, but are only counsel or guidance, and therefore ought not to be feared.

I am strongly opposed to the amendments that have been made. They concern congregational discipline and not qualifications for voting. "Access to the Lord's Supper" is a doubtful expression and altogether too indefinite. There ought to be an age limit. Whether 21 years is the most suitable may be a matter on which opinions differ. Yet this is fundamentally a conservative point, by no means so excessively progressive.

It was resolved to depart from the order of the day and hear the report of the Board of Trustees for Augsburg Seminary.

Prof. Oftedal then read a brief report, from which it appeared that, following the Supreme Court decision, Augsburg Seminary is hopefully secured for the Free Church. Augsburg's friends will rejoice over this and thank God and will not reproach their opponents.

The lawsuit has cost Augsburg about 5,000 dollars.

The school needs larger classrooms and more religious instruction in English.

The following were elected to the committee on the Board of Trustees' report: Pastor A. Houkom, Pastor J. H. Brønøs, Pastor G. Nilsen, J. Strandnes, and Ole Pedersen.

In the evening Pastors J. Tollefsen and S. M. Tollefsen preached in Trinity Church, and an offering was taken for the Deaconess Home.

Pastors Østgaulen and Ytrehus preached in St. Olaf's Church, Broen and Dahle in St. Luke's.
(To be continued.)

THE FREE CHURCH'S SECOND ANNUAL MEETING

(Continued from the previous No.)

1.7 Saturday Morning

Began from 9:00–9:30, led by Pastor H. Quambøl.

The minutes of the preceding meeting were read and adopted.

A telegram from N. C. Stubberud, Canton, S. Dak., was read.

Prof. Sverdrup reported for the committee on the Free Church's seal that the committee had chosen as its seal a Bible rose with many thorns. The significance of the rose in the Church has been Christ with his red blood in the thorn-filled world. The congregation shall also be a rose, and the thorns likewise belong to the fellowship of Christ. The Lord once revealed himself in a burning thornbush, and yet the bush was not consumed. Neither do we believe that the congregation of God shall be consumed.

The committee proposes that the seal be entrusted to the secretary of the Free Church for safekeeping. The proposal was adopted.

It was resolved to take up a collection at the close of the session to cover various expenses connected with the Annual Meeting.

It was resolved to proceed to the consideration of reports.

The committee on the president's report reported through Pastor Chr. Nyrehus.

Points 1, 2, 3, and 4 were adopted without debate and read as follows:

"1. The Annual Meeting of the Free Church hereby urges friends of the Free Church in all Lutheran congregations to come to our aid in our work for life and awakening in the congregations, so that through united, vigorous labor it may by the grace of God be possible for us to build up a true Lutheran Free Church in this country.

2. In order not to place hindrances in the way of brotherly cooperation, all friends of the Free Church are especially requested not, either publicly or privately, to use unnecessarily hurtful or offensive forms of expression toward ecclesiastical opponents.

3. We urge all friends of Augsburg to thank God that he continues to keep his protecting hand over Augsburg Seminary. And since the school is now secured for the purpose for which it was established, all friends of the school are urged to support its work in such a manner that it may bear rich fruit for the salvation of our people.

4. Pastor B. Nilsen is requested, as an emissary of the Free Church, to continue his activity for awakening and life in the congregations. He is to be paid as before, and Prof. Mohn is chosen to arrange his itinerary."

Point 5 required a measure of explanation.

"5. Candidate O. J. Edwards's ordination as pastor of Ebenezer Congregation, Greegs Co., N. Dak., performed by the deacons of that congregation, is recognized by the Free Church.

His certificate of ordination shall be signed by the ordinator and furnished with the seal of the Free Church."

Pastor Midthun desired information concerning this matter.

Pastor Nyestad desired the same, and further wished to know whether it was to become the practice in the future to recognize any ordination whatever performed out in the congregations. The speaker recalled the admonition: "let all things be done decently and in order." He was in doubt whether it was right simply to recognize this ordination without further consideration; for such things are not always done from the best motives.

Prof. Sverdrup gave the requested information in a lengthy account of the circumstances of the case. He also read a number of letters concerning the matter, among them letters from the president of Hauge's Synod and the head of Red Wing Seminary. Both gave Pastor Edwards the best testimony.

Pastor Quambøl stated that he was personally acquainted with Pastor Edwards and knew him to be a good man; he also knew the deacons who had laid their hands upon him, and they were, so far as he could understand, good men.

Pastor Edwards had good reason to break with Hauge's Synod, and the Free Church ought to recognize his ordination; otherwise it would not be true to its principles.

Pastor Nyestad believed, after the information that had been given, that it was right for the Free Church to recognize this ordination.

The point was adopted.

“6. Since the liquor traffic is a curse upon our country and people, and consequently an enemy of the congregation of God and of true, living Christianity, all friends of the Free Church are urged with all their strength and by all Christian means to oppose this institution and its corrupting influence. In particular, the attention of congregations and pastors is directed to the necessity that the cause of temperance be given more room in the public preaching of the congregation.”

Adopted.

The committee on the mission reports reported through Pastor C. C. Larsen.

“1. The Annual Meeting of the Free Church for 1898 hereby expresses its satisfaction with the steadily increasing interest with which the congregations and friends of missions have embraced the holy cause of mission during the past year.

2. The friends of missions and the congregations of the Free Church are most earnestly requested also in the coming year to remember the work of missions with intercession and generous contributions.

3. Since much blessing has been discerned from the meetings for conversation and edification, it is with joy and thanksgiving to the Lord that the congregations are requested to continue holding similar meetings also in the coming year.”

These points were adopted without debate.

“4. The budget proposal of the standing mission committees concerning appropriations for both home and foreign mission, amounting to \$10,000, is hereby approved by the Annual Meeting.”

Prof. Sverdrup: We can hardly appropriate anything; but we can nevertheless set ourselves the goal of collecting a certain amount, and 10,000 dollars is not much. We ought, and could, collect still more. I would like this side of our work to be held forward. If that is done, more will also be given; for our people are not so unwilling in this matter. When they see that a thing is good and necessary, they will also take part in furthering it.

It is now that it is to be tested whether we can make voluntary work succeed. And for this, instruction is needed.

Point 4 was adopted.

“5. It is left to the standing mission committees, according to their best judgment, to arrange the work both at home and abroad, and to determine how the contributions may best be used.

6. In accordance with the proposal of the Home Mission Committee, it is left to the new Mission Committee to call and appoint missionary pastors in the following places:

1) The district between Fosston and Bermidji.

2) Hawley and Detroit, Minn., together with the district around Wahpeton, N. Dak.; and, in addition—if the funds permit—two missionary pastors are to be appointed on the Pacific Coast, and mission support is to be granted to the Bella Coola Colony.

7. The Canadian Pacific R. R. and the Soo Line are thanked for the goodwill they have shown by granting free travel on their respective lines to Pastor E. Hage and family on their way to their future home in the Bella Coola Colony.

8. The friends of missions are most warmly encouraged to continue the good work already begun of supporting native teachers in the Madagascar mission field, just as the Annual Meeting rejoices with thanksgiving to God that last year’s recommendation has borne such blessed fruit.

9. The unexpected death and sudden passing of Deaconess Pernille Pedersen is received with sorrow by all friends of missions, because with her rich gifts for the work she seemed so indispensable to the young mission; but what seemed to be our loss was her gain, since it is our full assurance that she was permitted to enter into the joy of her Lord.

10. The Annual Meeting of the Free Church approves with thanks the Mission Committee’s sending forth of Sister Karoline Olsen.

11. The standing Mission Committee is authorized to issue a letter of call to Candidate Jørstad as missionary to Madagascar and to arrange everything concerning his departure as soon as possible.

12. The standing Mission Committee is authorized to pay whatever deficit there may be in Lou’s and Hogstad’s accounts on the mission field.

13. The Mission Committee’s proposal that Pastor Hogstad’s station be granted support of \$1,500 for 1898 is approved. In addition, the committee is authorized to provide Missionary Høigaard’s station with the necessary support this year and to pay Missionaries Lou and Hogstad their salaries.

14. Missionary Lou is among us after several years of foundational missionary work in Madagascar. The Annual Meeting bids him welcome among us.

The friends of missions and the congregations of the Free Church are requested to invite Pastor Lou to speak among them on the cause of missions, since it is our conviction that the visit will bear blessed fruit for the mission.”

Points 5–14 were adopted without debate.

“15. The Mission Committee is authorized—provided the funds permit—to call Dr. John Dyrnes as mission physician and missionary in Madagascar, and to make arrangements concerning his journey abroad and his stay in France.”

Pastor D. Paulson: We ought to rejoice that Dr. Dyrnes has offered himself to go out to the mission field as physician and missionary pastor. We would gladly send him, if only there is enough money.

Prof. Sverdrup explained that the French government prohibited anyone from practicing as a physician in Madagascar without a French diploma. The question therefore becomes whether it is possible for Dr. Dyrnes to obtain a French diploma. We believed that in any case it was necessary to send him to France for about a year to study medicine and French there. Others have succeeded in this way; possibly he too will succeed.

The expense of sending him to France and of one year's stay there will probably amount to around 600 dollars. We have good friends there who will certainly help him make the necessary arrangements.

If he receives a French diploma, he can practice among natives and Europeans and thereby possibly receive some income.

Medical mission is now regarded as absolutely necessary. The mission fields are for the most part unhealthy places, and sickness among the mission personnel is therefore common. Let us help in the manner of Jesus by not merely preaching the Word, but also bringing bodily help.

There are dreadful conditions of health among the natives. Alongside their own afflictions, European vices and diseases have been introduced among them, and these imported diseases cause a dreadful devastation among the savages. We have many examples of how savage nations simply waste away and die when they come into contact with civilization, which most often means coming into contact with vices in a peculiar manner.

If it is possible, so far as funds are concerned, to send Dr. Dyrnes, then it ought to be done. It appears to be a call from God.

The point was adopted.

“16. At this meeting a committee of three members shall be appointed to investigate whether our Heathen Mission Committee can be incorporated so that it may hold mission property in Madagascar, and in that case to present proposed articles of incorporation at next year's Annual Meeting.

17. The sisters at the Deaconess Home are thanked for the assistance they gave Sister Karoline Olsen upon her departure for the mission field.

18. The Paris Committee, with its secretary Pastor G. Büchfenschütz, and Pastor Sanders at St. Augustin are thanked for the help they have given our missionaries.”

Points 16–18 were adopted.

“19. It is left to the Mission Committee to call and send Candidate Haflem to the mission field, provided the funds permit.”

Prof. Sverdrup explained that Haflem from his very childhood had felt a drawing toward becoming a missionary to the heathen. He had also applied for admission to the Mission School in Stavanger, but did not obtain it, because it was feared that he was not strong enough. God nevertheless gave Haflem strength enough to travel to America and to work his way through school here. I believe it would be good to send him to France, to a school some distance from Paris, a kind of normal school, where he could study French and acquaint himself with the French school system. It would cost no more than about 12 dollars per month.

From there he could be sent to Madagascar and ordained by the missionaries there. It would then become the first ordination at the Augsburg Station.

The whole matter would cost around 300 dollars.

The point was adopted.

Prof. Sverdrup reminded the meeting that the committee had also recommended sending one more deaconess, which was sorely needed and did not cost so much.

The meeting resolved to leave it to the committee to act according to its best judgment in this matter.

The committee on the superintendent's report reported through Pastor C. Berlie.

"1. The Lutheran Free Church, assembled for meeting in Minneapolis, Minn., June 8-12, 1898, expresses its satisfaction with the outcome of the lawsuit and its joy that God also during the school year just concluded, amid the many tribulations and difficulties, has kept his gracious hand over Augsburg Seminary.

2. The Free Church rejoices over the rich fruit borne by the work at the theological school and hereby expresses its full satisfaction with the school's activity and its heartfelt thanks to the school's teachers and students because they have faithfully persevered in the work.

3. The members and friends of the Free Church are urged with love and willingness to sacrifice to gather around the theological school, being reminded of the great significance Augsburg Seminary has in the work toward the goal the Free Church has set for itself: living, free congregations.

4. The Free Church recommends that religious instruction in English be extended to additional classes in the preparatory departments and, as far as possible, to the theological department.

5. The Free Church thanks the superintendent of the Seminary because, alongside his other work, he has also conducted a class in French."

All these points were adopted.

As Point 6 the committee proposed that French be introduced as a regular subject in the College. In response, it was asked whether students could not then be permitted to choose between French and German. The general opinion appeared to be that German should continue to be a regular subject but French optional, and the following was therefore adopted as Point 6:

“6. Because of the Free Church’s mission in Madagascar, it is left to the faculty to arrange instruction in French in the College Department.

7. The Free Church recommends an early repair and enlargement of the buildings of Augsburg Seminary.”

Adopted.

1.8 Saturday Afternoon

Devotion by Emissary O. M. Andersen.

The committee on the report of the Board of Trustees reported through Pastor G. Nilsen.

The report was adopted point by point without discussion:

“1. The Norwegian Lutheran Free Church, assembled in Annual Meeting, hereby expresses its thanks to the Board of Trustees of Augsburg Seminary for the faithfulness and ability with which it has guarded the school and attended to its interests also in the school year now concluded. Likewise, we express our special thanks to Prof. Sven Oftedal for the persevering and self-sacrificing labor he has performed during the lawsuit now so happily concluded, in order to secure the theological school for our Norwegian Lutheran people in America.

2. In view of the influence which the lawsuit just concluded has had upon the friends of the Free Church, we rejoice all the more over the willingness to sacrifice with which the congregations have met the demands necessarily involved in operating the school, so that our debt to the school’s teachers amounts to only about \$3,000.

3. We express our thanks to Professors Hove, Rydahl, and Pettersen for the work they have performed in collecting money in the congregations for teachers’ salaries, and request Rydahl and Pettersen to continue this work throughout the summer, if possible, so that the aforementioned debt may be eliminated before the beginning of the next school year.

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4. This meeting requests the treasurer, Prof. Hove, to place himself at the head of a collection of \$1,000, to be used for the necessary repairs and taxes indicated by the chairman of the Board in his report.

This collection ought to be completed before the fall term begins.”

Pastor O. L. Torvik reported from the committee that had been appointed to deal with the question of an equal distribution of traveling expenses among the pastors of the Free Church, that the committee had not been able to bring the matter to realization for this Annual Meeting.

A committee of three members was appointed to arrange the matter during the course of the year.

The meeting then took up for consideration the edifying topic of conversation, “Times of Refreshing,” Acts 3:17–26.

Pastor C. Broen introduced the subject:

This is the conclusion of the second sermon Peter delivered after the outpouring of the Spirit. The occasion was the healing of the lame man. The people crowded together in amazement at the miracle that had taken place, and Peter used the opportunity to speak a word of truth to them. The Jesus whom you killed—he is the one who has done this miracle.

You killed the Prince of Life, whom God raised from the dead, of which we are witnesses. An awful thing, to kill God!

But I know that you did it in ignorance. This does not, however, remove the responsibility; but it gives hope of amendment. When a person does wrong in ignorance, there is hope that he will correct the wrong when he receives better light concerning the matter.

You must take on another mind, turn around. If you do so, then the times of refreshing shall come.

The times of refreshing embrace a great deal here. These persons, who have acted so hostilely toward God, shall receive forgiveness of sins and the gift of the Holy Spirit. They shall come into the same relation to God as the others who have become believers.

And then they will rejoice in the Lord’s coming. A glorious thought, this thought of the Savior’s return. Peter returns to it again and again in his preaching, in his letters.

It must have done them good to hear these things after the Apostle had laid their guilt so heavily upon them. The Lord has thought first of you. Make use of the opportunity now.

Did this sermon have any effect? That is told later. Many of those who had heard the Word believed, and the number of the men became nearly five thousand. Yes, this preaching had effect.

What are the times of refreshing? That individual persons turn from their sin to God, come to Christ, and become believers. It means more: times of spiritual renewal, times of awakening. There seem to be signs of something of that kind among us just now. There is considerable spiritual need here and there.

In order that the times of refreshing may truly come among us, we must receive the fullness of the Holy Spirit and the mind that makes us willing to sacrifice, to suffer—to live wholly for God. The Spirit must receive more complete and full control over our life. What wonders might not the Spirit accomplish with us and through us!

The times of refreshing mean still more: the spiritual deliverance, the Sabbath-rest that remains for the people of God. The pressure of the world, sin, and misery shall then have been taken away. One is free forever.

What prevents the times of refreshing from coming? It is impenitence. When people are humble and willing to deal openly with God, then the times of refreshing come. But when a

person goes about with a condemned conscience and will not allow the light of God's Word to penetrate the soul, then the refreshing cannot come.

Wrong relations within the family hinder the Spirit of God from entering.

The city of Nineveh had to clothe itself in sackcloth and ashes before the times of refreshing came; likewise Israel in Samuel's time, and the Norwegian people in Hauge's time.

How shall the times of refreshing come? How did they come upon the first congregation?

By their following of Jesus, the first disciples had been separated from the world, chosen by Jesus. They stood together as a fellowship of brothers and sisters. They were one in faith, hope, love, vision, longing, prayer. When people see alike, they also pray alike.

The banner of unity must take root among us—this gathering of God's children into one. There is much improvement in true fellowship of the Spirit among us. When God's children become united in common vision, common prayer, common labor, and so forth, then the Holy Spirit can come, and with him the times of refreshing. A great and serious battle is being prepared among us, and over this we rejoice.

What, then, accompanies the times of refreshing? Yes, what accompanied them among the first Christians? They received more life, greater power for labor, and so forth.

It was not burdensome to them to labor for Jesus—as it is for sluggish deacons and pampered officeholders among us. Opposition and persecution came for the first Christians; so also for us.

Pastor J. Tollefson: This is a very profitable subject. The Spirit does not come upon unbelief; for the world cannot receive him, but you shall receive him.

The believers are, as it were, to be mediators between Jesus and the unbelieving.

The great hindrance to the coming of the times of refreshing is this, that believers do not understand their position and task. They are to be the Lord's spokesmen and prophets, to speak of the love of God. When believers do not do this, they hinder the times of refreshing from coming.

Why are God's children thus in darkness? They have not searched the Scriptures. It is with them as with the disciples at Ephesus; they had not even heard tell of the Holy Spirit. It has not been clearly understood that one needs not only to receive Jesus, but also the Spirit in faith. The Holy Spirit is to be the spokesman in them, the guiding grace and power in the struggle and in the work.

Believers must begin to see what God's purpose and will are. It is upon the believers that the matter depends. They must receive the fullness of the Spirit in rich measure before the times of refreshing can come in truth. No work of mission to the heathen was done before the times of awakening came through Pietism, Methodism, and so forth.

It must become known that he who is in the believers is stronger than he who is in the world. When believers succeed in bringing others to Christ, then greater joy also comes over them, and thereby they receive new encouragement, strength, and boldness. The times of refreshing

shall come over the unconverted in that they are led to Christ, and over the believers in that they receive greater grace and power to testify concerning the Savior.

It is a corrupting doctrine, this teaching that one is to be so cautious about bearing witness. That there is much hypocrisy is true. But still it stands written in God's Word: You shall bear witness. What kind of Christianity is this that keeps silent about the great thing Jesus has done? Where one has been set free, there bold testimony arises.

Believers must learn to know their own foolishness; they must know where they are to carry themselves as believers.

Edvard Brethus: Many things hinder the Holy Spirit from coming to us. I will mention one thing: there is too little recognition of the Holy Spirit in believers' hearts. We do not love the Spirit; we do not long to receive him. We would not have been saved if the Holy Spirit had not been. If we understood the value of the Spirit, we would not merely pray for him, but truly wait to receive him. We pray like a man who knocks at the door but runs away again before it is opened.

The Holy Spirit is the most important thing for a Christian; we cannot live without the Spirit. This, I believe, is the times of refreshing: that one is refreshed by the Spirit from day to day.

Prof. Sverdrup: There is surely nothing people long for more than times of refreshing, or good times. Some think to obtain them by the way of the world, some by the way of the flesh, some by the way of God. To find the right way—that is the matter.

Many in this assembly need times of refreshing. We need joy, peace, power, faith, hope. What is lacking is not that the Spirit has not been poured out both once and twice. I have reservations about that manner of speaking according to which the Spirit comes twice—first the Spirit and then the fullness of the Spirit. God can give the Spirit in full measure at once; he can also cause the Spirit to increase. That former manner of speaking about the coming of the Spirit is misleading and can serve many as an excuse. For if it is true, then one may easily begin to reason in this way: "Well, I have received enough of the Spirit to be saved myself; but I have not received any special gift of the Spirit to labor for the salvation of others, therefore it is best that I keep quiet." See, in this way it can become an excuse for spiritual laziness.

The great hindrance to the coming of the Spirit is sin. A person does not have joy in the heart because he carries great sin. One is not refreshed by stretching oneself upward after an unknown power, but by descending.

Nothing torments a human being more than an unforgiven sin. Unhappy is the one who goes about with bitterness in the heart and sin upon the conscience. If we do not attain a good conscience, it is impossible to become happy. The intolerable relations between one person and another are a hindrance to the times of refreshing.

We all have an evil disposition, are sensitive to rebuke and to everything that goes against us. We are filled with bitterness, will not bow, but seek revenge. As long as we go about in that condition we cannot become glad. We cannot become glad as long as we carry inward, deep-seated rancor. How can the person become glad who is so situated that other people

can take his gladness from him?

It is otherwise with the one who has his joy in God; he has a fountain of joy that no one can take from him. When God is my refuge and my portion forever, then people may chastise and strike me as much as they will; in God my soul is nevertheless still, he is my rest, my peace, my joy.

If people are unloving toward me, then I feel that I have deserved it; but at the same time I also know that with Jesus there is forgiveness of sin, and that with him there is room and shelter also for me. The one who in contrition of heart and poverty of spirit takes refuge in the Lord shall experience what a time of refreshing is.

There is one word that expresses the greatest joy and blessedness, and that word is love. If we learn rightly to love, then we are blessed; for love is God. We must love in such a way that the love of Christ constrains us to offer ourselves for Christ by serving the brothers.

If faith takes the form that we are to believe in order that things may go well for us, then everything has been turned upside down; for to wish to serve God for reward is the very height of self-love.

If we try to obtain joy, peace, and blessedness by fulfilling God's commandments, we shall only become slaves under the Law and shall never attain any blessedness. No, one must let go of one's own righteousness and cast oneself into the Savior's arms; then peace, joy, and blessedness come. Then one will learn to love. Then one will be refreshed. Then one will also receive power to accomplish something for the Savior, for the Kingdom of God.

This love must be given to us; we cannot merit it or force it forth within ourselves.

But it is true that the times of refreshing are also times of suffering. We must make ourselves familiar with that. They are therefore not a millennial kingdom in this world. The times of refreshing among the first Christians lasted until the time when the congregation entered into alliance with the world; so also among us.

We are mistaken if we believe that the times of refreshing are to mean deliverance from suffering in this world. If we assert that, we act the hypocrite toward ourselves and toward the world, are dishonest, do shoddy work, and for that very reason cannot receive the times of refreshing.

If you would have happiness whole, blessedness full, then remember that it consists in this: that God dwells in you, that you become so small in yourself that God receives room within you and is permitted to be everything for you. The heart's peace and rest are in truth and in reality to be found with Jesus and nowhere else. But we are often too large to dwell with Jesus, and we are too proud to endure our Father's chastisement. That we have received power to become children of God—in this are the times of refreshing.

Pastor D. Paulson: When the Spirit of God bears witness with our spirit that we are children of God, then we are refreshed. Many in this assembly have experienced it. We cannot receive the times of refreshing unless the Spirit of God is permitted to do his work in our hearts. There are surely also those among us who have not experienced the times of refreshing, but who long for them and yet do not seem to attain them.

There are many hindrances; for example, that a person can see the faults of his fellow human beings so well, but not his own. I had occasion to see this in a woman not long ago. She was one of those who always found so many faults in others and constantly spoke about them. She herself was without peace and once called me to her in order to receive comfort.

When I came to her, she met me with a rebuke because I had spoken too favorably of someone recently deceased. I answered that perhaps this was true; for my fault has always been to think too well of people, and I have often come into difficulty and distress on that account. But then there are others who have the opposite fault, in that they always think too badly of people—and might you not be one of these? Perhaps this is also the reason that you receive no peace? You see the faults and sins of others, but not your own. You must come down to the place where you see yourself as a sinner before God and seek his forgiveness; only then will you find peace and become glad.

The poor woman acknowledged the truth of these words, and a new light dawned upon her; she became a different person from that day.

Pastor O. O. Wold: The more a person becomes obedient to the Spirit, so that the Spirit receives free rule in the heart, the more testimony there is. The fire of the Holy Spirit must burn away everything that is contrary to the Spirit of God. And God's children love this; but the unbelieving flee from it and become frightened. So they did on the Day of Pentecost.

We must be obedient to the Spirit by serving one another. We ought to be content with the lesser place, if only we may live for Christ and be together with brothers and sisters who love him.

J. Tollefson: I will only try to explain a little of what I said before. Humbling is necessary; so it was on the Day of Pentecost. There was deep conviction of sin among those who then received the Spirit.

A hindrance for many is that they slave under the Law instead of being under grace. The Spirit is not received through the Law, but through the preaching of faith.

The world must be won through the believers. It stands written that the Spirit works with them and confirms the Word. The Holy Spirit must do it; of ourselves we can do nothing.

O. Andersen: There are many things in us that we ourselves do not understand. I once read in a paper that so few believers are willing to be soldiers; they all want to be officers. They themselves want honor and do not give God the honor. Some become offended because God does not come to them in the way they themselves desire.

Spiritual ambition drives many to pass over what they are able to do in order to take hold of what they cannot manage. Let us begin where we have been placed, and let us not allow pride to stand as a hindrance to the times of refreshing. We must become willing to receive the Spirit as God wills, and to work where God places us.

Let us, for example, begin in the home among the little ones. We must not wait until we can hire a pastor or a teacher to raise the little ones. Let us ourselves raise them as before the face of God.

It was resolved to hear the report of the Ordination Committee.

The following candidates were recommended for ordination:

Candidate O. M. Batte, called as assistant pastor to Pastor Arne Berg in the Sverdrup, Stavanger, Tønseth, and Rindal congregations, Minn., for a period of at least six months.

Candidate John Mattson, called to the Madelia, Lincoln, and Rice Lake congregations, Minn.

Candidate Ole Swenson, called from Our Savior's Congregation, Chippewa Falls, Wis.

Candidate Knud J. Wang, called by the Scandinavian Norwegian-Danish Evangelical Lutheran Congregation, Windom, Minn.

Candidate Andreas Klaudius Lockrem, called by the Mission Committee to labor in the district between Fosston and Bermidje, Minn.

Candidate J. B. Jerstad, called as missionary to Madagascar.

Candidate A. J. Bartdal, called by Zion Congregation, Churchs Ferry, and affiliated congregations in N. Dak.

It was resolved that all the candidates recommended should be ordained.

The minutes were read and adopted.

The meeting concluded with hymn singing and prayer.

Saturday evening, sermon in Trinity Church by Pastor C. Hansen and Edv. Brethus.

Sunday morning, sermon at the principal service in Trinity Church by Missionary C. H. Tou. A mission offering of \$137.72 was collected.

Pastor N. Halvorsen preached in St. Luke's Church in the morning, and Pastors Kjelaas and Brønø on Sunday evening.

Pastor C. Berli preached in St. Petri Church on the East Side Sunday morning, and Pastor Chr. Næthus in St. Olaf's Church in North Minneapolis.

At 3 o'clock Sunday afternoon an ordination was held in Trinity Church, on which occasion Pastor H. A. Unseth announced the service and read the rite for the ordinands; Prof. Oftedal delivered the ordination address and performed the act of ordination.

In the evening, at the closing festival in Trinity Church, Pastor C. Aas, Prof. Sverdrup, Pastor Harbo, and Prof. Oftedal spoke.